Take A Peek At Our Lifesaving Medic Training Course

SAVE MORE LIVES IN ISRAEL

Medical "Kitot Konenut"
Establish Community First Response Teams

Presented to the Jewish Federation Bay Area

February 2026

JEWISH FEDERATION BAY AREA

UNITED HATZALAH

UNITED HATZALAH: AN EMERGENCY CALL EVERY 43 SECONDS

United Hatzalah is Israel's only nationwide, fully volunteer emergency medical service (EMS), and our mission is to save lives. We train and equip ordinary citizens, so they can provide free on-scene medical treatment to anyone in need during the critical window of time between the onset of the crisis and arrival of traditional ambulance assistance. While ambulances are often delayed, United Hatzalah volunteers are always nearby, giving choking, drowning, cardiac arrest, and other victims the best chance of survival. With our unique dispatch technology, innovative rapid response vehicles, and community-based volunteer network, our volunteers arrive to emergencies within minutes, and at times as fast as 90 seconds in metropolitan areas. In 2025, our National Dispatch Center received over 800,000 emergency calls. As the number of calls continues to rise, we are working to expand our volunteer network to 16,000 medics, with the ambitious goal of achieving a 90-second response for every emergency, anywhere in Israel.

On October 7, 2023, during the biggest catastrophe in Israel's history, our unique EMS model proved to be an indispensable resource; our brave volunteers entered the inferno in the early hours of Shabbat morning, establishing field hospitals and entering terrorist-controlled kibbutzim, treating thousands of people and saving hundreds of lives that day. We treated over 4,700 civilians and soldiers, provided psychological first aid to 2,700 Israelis suffering from emotional trauma, and evacuated 1,250 injured patients to hospitals via ambulance and helicopter. United Hatzalah's response was quick and coordinated, despite the many security, medical, and logistical challenges.

Since then, the organization has analyzed and debriefed hundreds of hours of phone calls, video footage, and reports from our emergency response that day, all of which point to the highest level of professionalism and unsurpassed volunteer dedication. This thorough assessment has also highlighted the need to further strengthen our EMS capabilities and preparedness for mass-casualty incidents (MCIs), ensuring that community-based teams of volunteer medics can come together effectively to save lives.

A grant of $1,000,000 will enable us to recruit, train, and equip four new community-based volunteer teams to serve as medical "kitot konenut". Each new team will consist of 25 volunteer medics, a total of 100 volunteers, ensuring that more of Israel's people receive fast, free, professional emergency medical care — on time, every time.

THE CHALLENGE: REACHING VICTIMS SWIFTLY

Medical emergencies strike at any time and can result in long-term disability or fatality if help does not arrive on time. While the human brain can only survive for four to six minutes without oxygen, the average ambulance response time in Israel is eleven minutes in cities and longer in rural areas. Dispatched from a fixed base, often far from the site of the emergency, and further delayed by traffic, traditional ambulances often arrive too late to save the life of a choking baby, elderly cardiac patient, or car accident victim.

Conversely, United Hatzalah's national network of volunteer medics — equipped with cutting-edge communication devices and innovative rapid response vehicles that navigate around traffic and roadblocks — arrive within three minutes or less to perform lifesaving treatment until the arrival of an ambulance, giving those in need the best chances of survival and recovery. Our volunteers, spotted at every medical emergency,

terror attack, and mass-casualty incident, have been dubbed "Angels in Orange" after their trademark orange jackets. You will find them first on scene reviving a heart in Holon, treating a rocket attack victim in Sderot, stabilizing a drowning child in Eilat, and treating psychological trauma after a terror attack in Jerusalem.

A United Hatzalah volunteer on scene can mean the difference between life and death.

URGENT NEED FOR ADDITIONAL MEDICAL "KITOT KONENET" TEAMS

Given the heightened threat of war, the need to train and equip additional medics across Israel to respond to both everyday emergencies and mass casualty incidents—and to improve access to critical, urgent medical care—has never been more urgent.

During the past two and a half years, Israeli citizens have had to endure heavy rocket fire, putting the lives of men, women, and children at risk. For United Hatzalah, this means that alongside answering routine emergency calls — such as household injuries, car accidents, cardiac arrests, work injuries, drownings, anaphylaxis, emergency births, and more — we must also be ready to provide on-scene emergency treatment related to war and terror injuries.

During large-scale emergencies, rapid response often depends on trained community-based teams that can immediately come together to manage these mass casualty incidents where communication is disrupted, or external backup cannot arrive in time. Establishing and strengthening local community response teams ensures that volunteer medics who live and work in the area are prepared to coordinate, triage, and provide lifesaving care during the critical first moments of a major emergency. The increased community first responders will ensure disaster preparedness, support the rebuilding of communities, and enhance local resilience.

Today, across the country, our volunteers arrive to emergencies within minutes, and 90 seconds in metropolitan areas, with the ambitious goal to achieve a 90-second response for every emergency by recruiting and training more medics. Every additional United Hatzalah volunteer increases the chance of a trained and equipped medic being in close proximity to an emergency, reduces response time, and improves patient outcome.

NEW VOLUNTEER TEAM SPONSORSHIP

The sponsorship of new medics will ensure fast, free, and professional EMS for Israel's people, and is comprised of the following components:

- **200-hour EMT course,** which covers emergency scenarios and medical treatment for every type of illness, accident, and act of violence, including written and practical tests.
- **Complete medic bags,** with everything a medic needs to save a life, including bandages, tourniquets, IVs, oxygen tanks, EpiPen injections, glucometers, defibrillators, and more.
- **Communication devices,** which allow United Hatzalah dispatchers to identify and alert volunteers to nearby emergencies, relay critical information, and coordinate response.
- **Internship period,** including 100 supervised emergency calls.

- **One year volunteer support,** including refresher courses, emergency drills, team meetings, volunteer insurance, medical supply refills, volunteer retention activities, and post-incident psychological counseling.

Anticipated project impact:

- As each volunteer responds to an average of 20 emergencies monthly, your new medic teams will assist **24,000+ citizens** annually for years to come – a great ROI on your gift.
- Enhanced disaster preparedness and community resilience.

GRANT REQUEST

With your grant of $1,000,000, we will launch four new medic teams called the Jewish Federation Bay Area "Medical Kitot Kenenut" or "Community First Response," teams. This transformational initiative will directly and immediately strengthen United Hatzalah's lifesaving capacity for emergency community response in Israel. Through this program, 100 newly recruited Jewish Federation Bay Area volunteers will be trained, equipped, and deployed to serve the residents of Israel, forming a coordinated, rapid-response volunteer medic network capable of reaching emergencies within minutes. Your Medical Kitot Kenenut will ensure a stronger and safer future for the people of Israel.

		Cost 25 volunteers ($US)	Cost 100 volunteers ($US)
Recruitment & Training	200-hour EMT training (including recruitment, learning materials & equipment, tests, certification)	30,000	120,000
Medical & Dispatch Equipment	Complete medic bag and communication device (including apps and licenses)	170,000	680,000
One Year Volunteer Support	Internship & 1-year volunteer support (including continued education, medical supply refill, insurance, recognition events, post-incident support)	50,000	200,000
Total		**$250,000**	**$1,000,000**

We will provide you with updates about the lives saved through your generous support. Thank you for your consideration of a lifesaving gift for United Hatzalah.

Whoever saves one life, saves the entire world
כל המקיים נפש אחת כאילו קיים עולם מלא
- Talmud -